BRANDLENS

Brand governance with receipts.

A review queue where every finding cites the guideline it violates, a person signs off on every decision, and the whole history stays auditable afterwards.

SUBMISSION PACK v1.0 · 7 November 2026

TRY IT IN FIFTEEN SECONDS

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Open the link, choose "Enter demo workspace" on the sign-in page. No account and no confirmation email.

judge@brandlens.demo · BrandLens-Judges-2026 · admin

Source code: github.com/ishmeettt/brandlens

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01 THE PROBLEM

Guidelines are written to be obeyed, and structured to be ignored.

Every brand team owns a document that says how the brand should look and sound: approved terms, banned claims, the palette, the logo rules. It is usually a PDF. It is almost never open at 4pm on a Friday, when somebody is writing the campaign that will carry it.

So the review collapses back onto memory and one bottleneck reviewer. Four things go wrong, every time:

- **The review bottleneck.** Every asset queues behind the one person who knows the guidelines by heart. Copy gets checked from memory, published, and corrected afterwards.
- **Confident AI, no evidence.** Point a general-purpose model at brand copy and it flags things that merely sound off-brand. It cannot show which clause it applied, so the finding cannot be verified, appealed, or trusted. Teams learn to ignore the checker.
- **Nothing survives the review.** When legal asks who approved a claim, the answer is a Slack thread. There is no record of which finding was raised, what it cited, and who overrode it.
- **Accessibility and colour drift quietly.** Alt text and contrast are the first things dropped under deadline, and nothing in the workflow notices they are gone.

> **WHY THIS MATTERS**
> The real cost is trust. A checker that cannot show its evidence is worse than no checker at all: it produces more work to argue about instead of work to fix. Brand governance fails not because the rules are unknown, but because the rules are never in the room when the decision is made.

02 THE SOLUTION

Evidence or silence: if a finding cannot cite an approved source, it does not ship.



BrandLens reviews a submission against the brand kit and returns findings that each carry the clause they violate and the exact passage they came from. The order of that pipeline is the whole idea: the cheap, provable checks run first, the expensive, arguable one runs last, and nothing reaches a reviewer without evidence.

- **Deterministic first.** Same content plus same kit always produces the same findings, in milliseconds, with no API key and no cost. Six rule families do the objective work: terminology, claims, alt text, colour, contrast and logo usage.
- **Evidence or silence.** A finding is only valid if it quotes a real passage from the brand kit. The citation gate checks every candidate against those passages; anything that fails is discarded and counted separately rather than shown as advice.
- **AI for judgement, not for guessing.** The model is handed the kit passages and may only return findings that quote them, capped at four per submission, and an empty list is a valid answer. Tone drift and weakly supported claims are the only things it is asked to add.
- **A human decides.** Findings are proposals. A reviewer accepts or dismisses each one, then approves or requests changes on the submission. Every decision is attributed to a person and stored.

> **THE DESIGN BET**
> Trust comes from restraint. Most AI review tools are impressive in the demo and unignorable in production because they are confidently wrong. BrandLens would rather return three findings a team can defend than thirty they have to triage.

03 WHAT WE BUILT

A working product, deployed and public, not a concept deck.

PAGE	WHAT IT DOES
/	Positioning and a three-step explainer of how a review actually runs.
/submit	Submit copy or an image. Text is analysed in place; images are read with OCR in the browser, so the file never leaves the device.
/review	The queue. Every finding shows its clause and passage, with accept and dismiss, live severity counters, and a submission-level approve or request-changes decision.
/brand-kit	The source of truth everything is judged against: guidelines, glossary, approved facts, palette, logo rules and a completeness score.
/admin	Workspace health from real aggregates: compliance rate, severity mix, most common violations, a 14-day trend, team and roles.

PAGE	WHAT IT DOES
/auth/sign-in	Supabase auth with admin, reviewer and creator roles, plus the one-click judge demo entry.

The rule catalogue, which is what makes the findings specific:

RULE	WHAT IT DETECTS	EXAMPLE FINDING
Terminology	Banned or discouraged words, preferred replacements, counted per occurrence.	"leverage" is discouraged; use "use".
Claims	Unsupported statistics, absolute superlatives, conflicting dates and facts.	"best in class", "10x faster" with no source.
Alt text	Images referenced without a description where the kit requires one.	Hero image shipped with no alt text.
Colour	Hex values outside the approved palette, with the nearest approved colour suggested.	#FF5733 is not in the palette; use #E8590C.
Contrast	WCAG 2.1 contrast ratio of text against its surface, light and dark.	3.1:1 against 4.5:1 required.
Logo	Non-approved logo assets used in a submission.	Outdated lockup used instead of the current one.

Under the surface:

- **Data model.** Four tables — profiles, brand_kits, content_submissions, findings — protected by 26 row-level security policies across three migrations. Tenant isolation and role boundaries are enforced in the database, not in the UI.
- **Stack.** Next.js 16 App Router, React 19, TypeScript and Tailwind on Supabase (Postgres, Auth, RLS), with tesseract.js for OCR and an optional OpenAI-compatible endpoint for the judgement pass. Deployed as a Cloudflare Worker.
- **Degrades safely.** With no environment variables the app runs read-only in demo mode instead of crashing, so the public demo never depends on a secret being present.

04 PROOF IT WORKS

Verified against the live deployment, not just on a laptop.

- **16 of 16 checks pass against the real policies.** The verify:supabase suite exercises signed-out denial, cross-tenant isolation and role boundaries against the actual database, not a mock.

- **End to end on the public deployment.** Demo sign-in, submit, review, accept a finding, watch the counters and the submission state change, then confirm the decision persisted through RLS on reload.

- **A seeded workspace to test against.** Four submissions across states, eleven findings (nine pending, one accepted, one rejected), one brand kit at full completeness, five profiles. Reproducible with npm run seed:demo.

- **Public by default.** A live Cloudflare-hosted preview and an open-source repository of 47 files with no credentials in it. The demo workspace holds seeded sample data, which is why the judge credentials are printed on the cover.

> **HONEST STATUS**
> This is a complete vertical slice of the whole loop — ingest, review, decide, record — for text and image submissions. Ingesting PDF and DOCX files, and meeting writers inside Figma or Docs, is Round 3 work and is listed as such.

05 ROUND 3 PLAN

From a judged demo to a pilot that one real team can run for a month.

The plan is ordered by what a first design partner hits in week one: the review has to happen where the work is being made, it has to cover the formats teams actually ship, and it has to leave behind evidence that legal will accept. Each workstream has a single, checkable definition of done.

WORKSTREAM	DELIVERABLES	DONE WHEN
1 Meet content where it is made	A read-only Figma plugin, a Google Docs add-on, and a GitHub Action plus inbound webhook for CMS pipelines.	A campaign is checked before approval, not after publication.
2 Ingest what teams ship	Server-side PDF and DOCX text extraction, server OCR for image assets, and batch review of a whole asset set.	Every format the brand kit lists is reviewed with citations.
3 Governance operations	Reviewer assignment and SLAs, exemptions that expire and name an approver, per-submission decision history, an exportable audit pack, and email or Slack notifications.	Legal can answer "who approved this claim" without asking anyone.
4 Trust and scale	Append-only signed audit events, SSO (SAML or OIDC) with SCIM, per-workspace isolation and quotas, and an eval harness that scores AI citation precision on a fixed corpus.	It survives a security review and a pilot with two teams.

Six-week sequence:

WEEKS	FOCUS	MILESTONE
1–2	Decision history, audit export, CI check on pull requests.	First design partner runs a real review in their own workflow.
3–4	PDF and DOCX ingestion, Docs add-on, assignments and SLAs.	Whole campaigns reviewed, not single strings of copy.
5–6	SSO, signed audit log, eval harness, and pilot hardening.	A paid pilot signed with a team outside this hackathon.

The numbers we will hold ourselves to:

- **Citation precision stays at 100%** by construction, and is measured continuously on the AI-only subset so the gate cannot quietly erode.
- **Median time to first finding under 60 seconds** inside the editor, because a review that takes longer than the writing does not get run.
- **Share of submissions approved with zero high-severity findings** tracked per workspace — the only number that shows governance is actually working.
- **Reviewer decisions per hour** watched alongside false-positive rate, so the queue optimises for the human rather than for the model.

Risks, and how we retire them:

RISK	WHY IT MATTERS	HOW WE RETIRE IT
A clever paraphrase still cites a real clause	The gate proves the quote exists, not that the finding is the most useful one.	The AI pass is capped at four findings and never blocks a submission on its own; its precision is measured separately.
Model drift changes the findings	A different endpoint or model version quietly changes what gets flagged.	Version-pinned model, a fixed replay corpus run before any upgrade, and a deterministic layer that is unaffected.
Noise kills adoption faster than misses	One team burned by false positives stops opening the queue.	Per-workspace false-positive rate is visible on Admin, and rule thresholds are per-kit rather than global.

DELIBERATELY OUT OF SCOPE

Generative rewriting. BrandLens flags and cites; it does not rewrite your copy, because the person who wrote it is still the best judge of what it should say. A tool that rewrites also becomes the thing being reviewed.

06 TRY IT YOURSELF

Everything described here is in the running product.

WHERE	LINK OR VALUE
Live demo	site-4dde5f48239247f79cb0cf1b59ab161c.freebuff.page
Source code	github.com/ishmeettt/brandlens
Judge access	judge@brandlens.demo · BrandLens-Judges-2026 (admin)
Reset the data	npm run seed:demo — idempotent, rebuilds the sample workspace

Where to look first:

- **Every finding carries its evidence.** Open Review. Each card names the clause it applied and quotes the passage it came from, so you can check the reasoning instead of trusting it.
- **Follow a single decision.** Accept a finding, then reload the page. The decision persisted in Postgres through row-level security, and the submission state and counters moved with it.
- **The numbers are computed.** The compliance rate, severity mix and 14-day trend on Admin are aggregates over the findings table, not illustrative mock values.

The fastest path: open the demo, sign in, go to Review, accept one finding, then open the submission decision.

Built for the BrandLens hackathon submission, November 2026.